

Word family: **class / classes / classed / classing / classify / classification / classified**

Base word: class

Plural: classes

Verb forms: class, classes, classed, classing

Related family: classify, classification, classified

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / related verb and noun forms (相關動詞及名詞)

Useful constructions/extensions: class lesson, English class, class of students, graduating class, class of objects, social class, working class, middle class, first class, business class, world-class, class act, class someone as, classify, classification, classified information

Your passage contains:

> “Her influence did not end when the **classes ended**.”

Here, **classes** means:

scheduled teaching sessions or lessons.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **when the classes ended**

you are referring to the formal English lessons Mrs. Chan taught.

The sentence means:

> the scheduled teaching sessions stopped

> but

> her influence continued.

Meaning: A period/session in which students are taught a subject.

繁體中文： **課堂；一節課；上課時段**

中文翻譯：

> “Her influence did not end when the classes ended.”

「她的影響並沒有隨著**課堂結束**而停止。」

So:

****class = lesson / teaching session****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****class = lesson / teaching session (課堂 ; 一節課) — 課 ; 上課時段****

This is the exact passage sense.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Her influence did not end when the ****classes ended****.”

「她的影響並沒有隨著**課堂結束**而停止。」

Practice 2

> “I have an English ****class**** at ten.”

「我十點有一節英文****課****。」

Practice 3

> “The class lasted fifty minutes.”

「這節****課****持續了五十分鐘。」

****class = 老師在特定時段教授學生的一節課 / 課堂****

2. ****class = course/subject session (某科課堂) — 某一科的課****

Practice 4

> “She teaches a writing ****class****.”

「她教授一門寫作****課****。」

Practice 5

> “Math class starts after lunch.”

「數學**課**午飯後開始。」

****class = 某一科目 / 技能的教學課程或課堂****

3. ****class = group of students taught together (班級 ; 全班學生) — 班 ; 全班****

A major separate sense.

Practice 6

> “The whole ****class**** listened carefully.”

「****全班學生****都仔細聽。」

Practice 7

> “She has a class of thirty students.”

「她教一個有三十名學生的****班級****。」

****class = 一起接受教學的一組學生****

4. ****the class = students collectively (全班) — 全班同學****

Practice 8

> “The teacher asked the ****class**** a question.”

「老師問了****全班同學****一個問題。」

Practice 9

> “The class laughed.”

「****全班****都笑了。」

****the class = 把同一班學生視為一個整體****

5. **class** = year/cohort (屆 ; 級) — 某一屆學生

A major educational use.

Practice 10

> “She was in the **class** of 2020.”

「她是 **2020 屆**學生。」

Practice 11

> “The graduating class celebrated together.”

「**畢業班 / 畢業屆**學生一起慶祝。」

class = 同一時期入學 / 畢業的一屆學生

6. **class** = group/category (類別) — 類 ; 種類

A major abstract sense.

Meaning: A group of things sharing common features.

Practice 12

> “This belongs to a different **class** of problem.”

「這屬於另一**類**問題。」

Practice 13

> “These animals form a separate class.”

「這些動物構成另一個**類別**。」

class = 根據共同特徵劃分出來的一組人 / 事物

7. **class** of object/product/problem (某一類) — 類別 ; 種類

Practice 14

> “This is a new **class** of product.”

「這是一種新的**產品類別**。」

Practice 15

> “That belongs to a different class of risk.”

「那屬於不同**類型的風險**。」

class = 具有相似性質、功能或特徵的分類單位

8. **class** = taxonomic/scientific category (科學分類階級) — 綱 ; 分類級別

A major domain meaning.

Practice 16

> “Mammals belong to a biological **class**.”

「哺乳動物屬於一個生物分類的**綱**。」

Practice 17

> “The species is placed in a different class.”

「這個物種被歸入另一個**分類級別**。」

class = 生物學 / 科學分類中的正式層級

This is learner-relevant for academic English.

9. **class** = social class (社會階級) — 階級 ; 社會階層

A major genuinely distinct sense.

Practice 18

> “The novel explores differences in **social class**.”

「這本小說探討**社會階級**差異。」

Practice 19

> “Class influenced access to education.”

「**社會階層**影響了接受教育的機會。」

class = 依收入、職業、教育、社會地位等形成的社會階層

10. **working class / middle class / upper class** (工人階級 / 中產 / 上層階級) — 社會階層

Practice 20

> “He grew up in a **working-class** family.”

「他在一個**工人階級家庭**長大。」

Practice 21

> “The area became increasingly middle class.”

「那個地區逐漸變得更加**中產化**。」

class = 社會經濟地位所形成的階層

11. **class** = rank/standard/quality (等級 ; 水準) — 級別 ; 品質層次

A major evaluative sense.

Practice 22

> “The hotel is in a different **class**.”

「這間酒店屬於完全不同的**檔次**。」

Practice 23

> “Her performance was in a class of its own.”

「她的表現**自成一格 / 遠超一般水準**。」

class = 品質、能力或水準所屬的等級

12. **in a class of its own (自成一格；無與倫比) — 獨一無二；特別出色**

A major idiom.

Practice 24

> “Her voice is **in a class of its own**.”

「她的聲音**自成一格 / 無與倫比**。」

Practice 25

> “That design is in a class of its own.”

「那個設計**獨一無二 / 遠超同類**。」

in a class of its own = 水準 / 特色遠超一般同類，幾乎無法直接比較

13. **class = elegance / stylish quality (氣質；品味) — 高雅；有格調**

A major informal evaluative sense.

Practice 26

> “She has real **class**.”

「她很有**氣質 / 格調**。」

Practice 27

> “The event was organized with class.”

「活動辦得很**有格調**。」

class = 優雅、品味、成熟得體的風格或氣質

This is not social class.

14. **have class (有品味 / 有氣質) — 有格調；有風度**

Practice 28

> “He handled the situation with **class**.”

「他很有**風度地**處理了那件事。」

Practice 29

> “She has a lot of class.”

「她很有**氣質 / 品味**。」

have class = 表現優雅、得體、有風度或有品味

15. **class act** (非常出色 / 有風度的人) — 一流人物 ; 很有風度的人

A common idiom.

Practice 30

> “She’s a real **class act**.”

「她真的是個**很有風度 / 很出色的人**。」

Practice 31

> “He was a class act even in defeat.”

「即使輸了，他仍然表現得**非常有風度**。」

class act = 行為、能力或人格令人尊敬、顯得非常成熟出色的人

16. **first class / second class / business class** (等級 ; 艙等) — 頭等 / 二等 / 商務艙

A major transport/service meaning.

Practice 32

> “They travelled **first class**.”

「他們乘坐**頭等艙 / 頭等座**。」

Practice 33

> “She booked a business-class seat.”

「她訂了一個**商務艙座位**。」

class = 交通、服務等按價格和待遇劃分的等級

17. **first-class = excellent (第一流的) — 一流 ; 優秀**

A major lexicalized adjective.

Practice 34

> “She did a **first-class job**.”

「她做得**一流 / 非常出色**。」

Practice 35

> “The service was first-class.”

「服務是**一流的**。」

first-class = 品質非常高、出色

This extends beyond literal transport categories.

18. **world-class (世界級的) — 世界頂尖**

A major compound.

Practice 36

> “She is a **world-class athlete**.”

「她是一位**世界級運動員**。」

Practice 37

> “The city has world-class facilities.”

「這個城市有**世界級設施**。」

****world-class = 達到全球最高水準之一****

19. ****class = verb: place in a category (歸類) — 分類；歸為****

A major verb sense.

Practice 38

> “The material is ****classified as hazardous****.”

「這種材料被****歸類為危險物質****。」

Practice 39

> “I would class this as a serious problem.”

「我會把這****歸類為嚴重問題****。」

****class X as Y = 把 X 歸入 Y 類別****

20. ****class someone/something with (把.....歸在一起) — 歸類；並列****

Practice 40

> “These two products are often ****classified together****.”

「這兩種產品經常被****歸為同類****。」

Practice 41

> “I would not class him with the top performers.”

「我不會把他****列入頂尖表現者之列****。」

****class = 根據特徵、品質或標準把人 / 事物歸入某類****

21. ****classify = categorize systematically (分類) — 分類；歸類****

A major related verb.

Practice 42

> “The data were **classified** into three groups.”

「數據被**分成三類**。」

Practice 43

> “Scientists classify animals according to shared features.”

「科學家根據共同特徵**分類動物**。」

classify = 按照系統、規則或共同特徵把事物劃分成類別

22. **classification** (分類；類別系統) — 分類；分類法

Practice 44

> “The **classification** is based on size.”

「這個**分類**以大小為依據。」

Practice 45

> “The system uses a simple classification scheme.”

「這個系統使用一套簡單的**分類方法**。」

classification = 把事物分類的行為 / 結果 / 分類系統

23. **classified** = officially categorized (被正式分類的) — 被歸類的

Practice 46

> “The product is **classified** as medical equipment.”

「這件產品被**歸類為醫療設備**。」

Practice 47

> “The area is classified as high risk.”

「該地區被**列為高風險地區**。」

classified as = 被正式放入某個類別

24. **classified = secret/restricted (機密的) — 機密；保密**

A genuinely separate lexicalized adjective.

Practice 48

> “The document is **classified**.”

「這份文件是**機密文件**。」

Practice 49

> “They were not allowed to share classified information.”

「他們不得分享**機密資料**。」

classified information = 因安全、政府或組織規定而限制公開的資訊

This is not simply “categorized information.”

25. **classification = security level (保密級別) — 機密分類級別**

A related domain use.

Practice 50

> “The document’s security **classification** was changed.”

「文件的安全**保密級別**被更改了。」

Practice 51

> “Different files have different classification levels.”

「不同文件有不同的**機密等級**。」

****classification = 對敏感資訊所設定的安全 / 保密級別****

26. ****class = programming/software class (類別) — 類 ; 類別****

A major technical sense.

Practice 52

> “The program defines a new ****class****.”

「程式定義了一個新的****類別****。」

Practice 53

> “Each object belongs to a class.”

「每個物件都屬於某個****類別****。」

****class = 物件導向程式設計中，定義物件屬性和行為的藍圖 / 類型****

Useful for technical learners.

27. ****class = group in statistics/data (資料類別) — 類別 ; 分組****

Practice 54

> “The values were divided into several ****classes****.”

「數值被分成幾個****組別 / 類別****。」

Practice 55

> “Each class contains a range of values.”

「每個****組別****包含一個數值範圍。」

****class = 統計 / 資料分析中按範圍或特徵劃分的組別****

Important distinction: ****class vs lesson****

This is one of the most important learner contrasts.

class

can mean:

- * lesson session;
- * group of students;
- * course context.

lesson

mainly means:

- * a particular period/unit of teaching;
- * something learned from experience.

Compare:

> “I have English **class** at ten.”

= 十點有英文課。

> “Today’s **lesson** is about grammar.”

= 今天這一課的內容是文法。

They overlap, but **lesson** focuses more on the teaching unit/content.

Important distinction: **class vs course**

class

can be one session:

> “I have class at nine.”

course

usually means:

> a whole organized programme of study over weeks/months.

So:

> course = entire programme

> class = often individual session/group

Regional English can blur this distinction.

Important distinction: **class vs school**

school

= institution/system.

class

= lesson or group within that institution.

You can:

> go to school

and then:

> attend several classes.

Important distinction: **class = lesson vs class = students**

Compare:

> “The **class** begins at nine.”

= 課堂九點開始。

> “The **class** laughed.”

= 全班學生笑了。

Same noun, but one refers to:

> teaching session

and the other to:

> people.

Important distinction: **class vs grade**

class

= group of students / lesson / category.

grade

in educational contexts can mean:

- * school year level;
- * mark/result.

For example:

> Grade 8

is a year level.

> an English class

is a teaching group/session.

Important distinction: **class vs category**

class

and:

category

both can mean a group based on similarities.

But **category** is broader and more neutral.

Class often appears in:

- * science;
- * systems;

- * formal classification;
- * social ranking.

Important distinction: **class vs type**

type

= kind/form based on features.

class

= category in an organized classification system.

> “a type of problem”

is ordinary.

> “a class of compounds”

sounds more formal/scientific.

Important distinction: **class vs group**

group

= any collection of people/things.

class

= group formed because members share a category, level, educational context, or defining features.

A group does not necessarily belong to a classification system.

Important distinction: **social class vs classroom class**

social class

= socioeconomic/social-status grouping.

school class

= group of students / teaching session.

Completely different meanings despite same noun.

Important distinction: **class vs status**

class

= broader social/economic category.

status

= someone's relative social position/prestige.

They overlap but are not identical.

Important distinction: **class = quality vs social class**

Compare:

> "She has **class**."

= 她很有氣質 / 格調。

Not:

> she belongs to a particular social class.

Context completely changes the meaning.

Important distinction: **have class vs be classy**

have class

= behave with elegance, maturity, and good taste.

classy

= stylish/elegant; sometimes can sound informal.

> “She handled it with class.”

emphasizes behaviour.

Important distinction: **class act** vs **good person**

class act

= someone who behaves exceptionally well, often with professionalism or grace.

It can praise:

- * conduct;
- * competence;
- * character.

It does not simply mean morally good.

Important distinction: **first class** vs **first-class**

first class

as noun/adverb:

> travel first class.

first-class

before a noun:

> a first-class service.

Hyphenation depends on grammatical role.

Important distinction: **first class** vs **world-class**

first-class

= excellent / highest standard.

****world-class****

= among the best internationally.

****World-class**** is usually stronger.

Important distinction: ****class vs rank****

****class****

= category/level.

****rank****

= relative position within a hierarchy.

Two people can belong to the same class but have different ranks.

Important distinction: ****class vs classify****

****class****

as a verb:

> class X as Y

= place X in a category.

****classify****

= systematic/general verb for categorization.

****Classify**** is much more common in technical/formal writing.

Important distinction: ****classed as vs classified as****

Both can mean:

> regarded/placed in a category.

classed as

slightly more general/BrE-friendly.

classified as

often sounds more formal/systematic/official.

Important distinction: **classified = categorized vs classified = secret**

Compare:

> “The animal was **classified as** endangered.”

= 被歸類為瀕危。

versus:

> “The report is **classified**.”

= 報告是機密的。

Same word, very different meaning.

Important distinction: **class of 2020 vs class in 2020**

class of 2020

= students graduating/associated with that year.

class in 2020

= a lesson/group that happened during the year 2020.

Very different.

Important distinction: **in a class of its own vs first-class**

in a class of its own

= so distinctive/superior it is hard to compare.

first-class

= very high quality.

The former emphasizes uniqueness.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **class** family is very rich across education, categorization, social structure, quality, transport, and technical classification:

- * **class — lesson** = 課堂 / 一節課
- * **class — subject session** = 某科課
- * **class — students** = 班級 / 全班
- * **class of 2020** = 2020 屆
- * **class — category** = 類別
- * **class — scientific category** = 科學分類級別
- * **social class** = 社會階級
- * **working/middle/upper class** = 工人 / 中產 / 上層階級
- * **class — standard/quality** = 等級 / 檔次
- * **in a class of its own** = 自成一格 / 無與倫比
- * **class — elegance** = 氣質 / 格調
- * **have class** = 有風度 / 有品味
- * **class act** = 很有風度 / 很出色的人
- * **first/business/second class** = 服務 / 艙等級別
- * **first-class** = 一流
- * **world-class** = 世界級
- * **class — verb** = 歸類
- * **class X as Y** = 把 X 歸為 Y
- * **classify** = 系統地分類
- * **classification** = 分類 / 分類法
- * **classified as** = 被正式歸類為
- * **classified information** = 機密資料
- * **class — programming** = 程式設計中的類別
- * **class — statistical grouping** = 資料分組 / 類別

The main semantic branches are:

> **teaching session**

> ****group of students****

> ****category/type****

> ****social/economic grouping****

> ****quality/status level****

> ****elegance/style****

> ****service/travel level****

> ****verb: categorize****

plus important technical extensions in:

> ****science, computing, statistics, and security classification****

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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class — lesson	老師在特定時段教授學生的一節課 / 課堂
class — students	一起接受教學的一組學生 / 全班
class — cohort	同一時期入學、畢業或被視為同屆的一群學生
class — category	根據共同特徵劃分出來的一組人 / 事物
scientific class	正式科學分類體系中的一個分類層級
social class	根據收入、職業、教育、社會地位等形成的社會階層
class — standard/quality	品質、能力或水準所屬的等級 / 檔次
in a class of its own	水準或特色遠超一般同類、自成一格
class — elegance	優雅、品味、成熟得體的氣質 / 風格
class act	行為、能力或風度非常出色而令人尊敬的人
travel/service class	按價格、待遇或服務水平劃分的等級
first-class	品質非常高、一流的
world-class	達到全球最高水準之一的
class — verb	根據特徵 / 標準把人或事物歸入某個類別
classify	按系統、規則或共同特徵進行分類
classification	分類的行為、結果或分類制度
classified as	被正式放入某個類別
classified — secret	因安全 / 政府規定而限制公開的機密資訊
programming class	物件導向程式設計中定義物件結構與行為的類別 / 藍圖

For your original passage

> “Strictly speaking, I was only her student for two years, but her influence did not end when the
classes ended.”

The exact meaning is:

class = a scheduled lesson / teaching session

Therefore:

> **the classes ended**

= **「那些課堂 / 正式上課時段結束了」**

This matters because **class** here does **not** mean:

> the students,

and it does **not** mean:

> social class,

and it does **not** mean:

> category.

The contrast in your sentence is:

> **classes ended**

> = formal teaching stopped

but:

> **influence continued**

> = the personal impact remained.

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **English class**

> = 英文課

> **the class laughed**

> = 全班學生笑了

> **class of 2020**

> = 2020 屆

> **a class of problems**

> = 一類問題

> **social class**

> = 社會階級

> **working class**

> = 工人階級

> **in a class of its own**

> = 自成一格 / 無與倫比

> **she has class**

> = 她很有氣質 / 風度

> **class act**

> = 很有風度 / 很出色的人

> **first class**

> = 頭等 / 最高等級

> **first-class service**

> = 一流服務

> **world-class athlete**

> = 世界級運動員

> **class the item as dangerous**

> = 把該物品歸類為危險品

> **classify the data**

> = 將數據分類

> **classified information**

> = 機密資訊

So **class** is much richer than simply:

> **class = 課堂**

The key semantic map is:

CLASS — education

→ lesson/session

→ group of students
→ graduating cohort

****CLASS — categorization****
→ type/category
→ scientific/technical grouping

****CLASS — society/status****
→ social class
→ quality/level
→ elegance

****CLASS — service level****
→ first class / business class

****CLASS — verb****
→ categorize / classify

And in your original passage:

****class = “the formal English teaching sessions that ended after two years, even though Mrs. Chan’s influence continued.”****